



PURPLE BANNER ALERT



Local SHW Notice

Type of Notification:	General Advice	Date:	31/03/2023
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Summary Statement:	Safety Signage at Excavations
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Details:

The Minimum WHS Control Standards (Works and Services) contains several requirements in relation to excavation and trenching. These requirements specify the safe work practices that must be in place where there is a bench, batter, or shoring ground support system in place.



Non – Compliant Excavation Signage

Under the Minimum WHS Control Standards (Works and Services), excavations and trenches must:

- Have adequate safety signage at appropriate locations around the trench in accordance with AS 1319 (*Safety signs for the occupational environment*); and
- Meet any specified requirements in the Code of Practice – Excavation.

The Code of Practice – Excavation provides the following guidance:

- Where a person is at risk due to excavation, Regulation 3.109(1) states:
If, at a workplace where excavation work is to be done, any person is at risk of injury because of the excavation work then a person who, at the workplace, is an employer, the main contractor or a self-employed person must ensure that — (a) suitable barriers are erected between the person at risk and the likely cause of the danger; and (b) suitable signs that warn of the risk are erected at the place where the excavation work is to be done.
- Signs should be placed at appropriate locations around the perimeter of the excavation where they can be easily seen.
- Signs should comply with the requirements of AS 1319.

Under the Traffic Management for Works on Roads Code of Practice, the signs:

- Must be sourced from an approved sign maker; this ensures the sign sheeting materials are in accordance with the required standards.

AS 1742.3 (*Manual of uniform traffic control devices*) contains requirements in relation to:

- Sign format
- Sign size; and
- Retroreflective material used on signs for works on roads.

For excavation protection requirements near roadways, please see Austroads Guide to Temporary Traffic Management (AGTTM) Part 3, Section 6.8 – Excavations.

Note: This banner alert is specifically addressing the safety signage required for Excavations.

For more controls and protection requirements, please refer to:

- Code of Practice – Excavation
- Main Roads WA Minimum WHS Control Standards
- Austroads Guide to Temporary Traffic Management (AGTTM)
- Code of Practice – Works on Roads

Action(s) Required:

Ensure that where excavation and trenching work is carried out, an appropriate number and type of signage is available for installation.

Distribution of Notice:

South West Region